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Quinn Pfeifer

Education

University of Washington
Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science and Engineering and Department of Mathematics September 2023 -

- Dean's List all quarters
- Graduate-level coursework
- Double major in Computer Science and Mathematics
- Notable CSE coursework: CSE 311, 312, 331, 332, 333, 351, 421, 442, 455, 461, 473, 478, 546, 547, 579
- Notable MATH coursework: MATH 207, 209, 224, 300, 394, 395, 407

Experience

Personal Robotics Lab at University of Washington
Undergraduate Research Assistant October 2023 -

- Worked with Ph.D. students and Professors to develop state-of-the-art Imitation Learning algorithms that outperform humans and other baselines
- Submitted papers to top robotics conferences and journals
- Performed research on real-world platforms and became familiarized with full-stack robotics including perception, control theory, simulated dynamics, and Imitation and Reinforcement learning in a real-world robotic setting

Intent Lab at Carnegie Mellon University
Robotics Institute Summer Scholar June 2026 - August 2026

Publications

Quinn Pfeifer, Ethan Pronovost, Paarth Shah, Khimya Khetarpal, Abhishek Gupta, Siddhartha Srinivasa, (2026). "Difference-Aware Retrieval Polices for Imitation Learning". In: *The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations*. URL: https://github.com/WEIRDLabUW/darp-site.

Abhay Deshpande, Maya Guru, Rose Hendrix, Snehal Jauhri, ... **Quinn Pfeifer**, ... Dieter Fox, Ali Farhadi, Georgia Chalvatzaki, Dhruv Shah, Ranjay Krishna, (2026). "MolmoB0T: Large-Scale Simulation Enables Zero-Shot Manipulation". In: *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.16861*. URL: https://allenai.github.io/MolmoBot/. **Best Paper Award, ICRA 2026 Workshop "From Data to Decisions"**.

Quinn Pfeifer*, Abirami Subramanian*, Aidan Lee*, ... Rick Rupan, Alnis Smidchens, (2025). "UWROV 2025 Technical Documentation". In: *Journal of Ocean Technology* 20.3, pp. 1–24.

Abhay Deshpande, Liyiming Ke, **Quinn Pfeifer**, Abhishek Gupta, Siddhartha S. Srinivasa, (2024). "Data Efficient Behavior Cloning for Fine Manipulation via Continuity-based Corrective Labels". In: *International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (Oral)*. URL: https://personalrobotics.github.io/CCIL/.

* denotes equal contribution

Recreational Robotics

Underwater Remotely Operated Vehicles (UWROV)
Lead Software Developer August 2024 -
Software Developer October 2023 - August 2024

- Developed software for world-class ROV for participation in the MATE ROV competition
- Developed Photogrammetry and SfM algorithm to create 3D scans of the ocean floor and extrapolate ROV position in 3 dimensions

Husky Robotics
Software Developer October 2023 - September 2025

- Developed software for a world-class imitation Mars rover for competition in the University Rover Challenge
- Worked with React applications and Unity-based simulations for Rover control and navigation, both teleoperated and autonomous

Awards

Academic

- 2023-Present - Dean's List all quarters, University of Washington
- 2025 - Mary Gates Research Scholarship, University of Washington
- 2023 - President's Distinction (4.0 GPA), Everett Community College (Running Start)

MATE (UWROV)

- 2025 - NOAA Ocean Exploration Video Challenge Winner (Lead Developer)
- 2025 - Engineering Presentation World Champions
- 2025 - Technical Documentation World Champions
- 2025 - Sharkpedo Legacy Innovation Award